



(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Radler

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(54) **TRADESCANTIA PLANT NAMED ‘RADTRAD’**

(50) Latin Name: *Tradescantia virginiana*
Varietal Denomination: **Radtrad**

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patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 104 days.

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(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./263.1**

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new *Tradescantia* plant is provided that displays a spread-
ing mounded growth habit. The new variety commonly flow-
ers from June to November and forms in abundance large
purple flowers in clusters on a substantially uniform basis.
The plant propagates well through the use of cuttings. An
additional choice is provided to gardeners seeking an herba-
ceous perennial. Attractive linear green leaves with substan-
tially parallel venation are formed. The plant is well suited for
providing colorful distinctive ornamentation.

2 Drawing Sheets

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Botanical/commercial classification: *Tradescantia virgini-
ana*/Spiderwort.

Varietal denomination: cv. Radtrad.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The new *Tradescantia virginiana* variety of the present
invention is a member of the Commelinaceae family and was
discovered during 2007 as a seedling growing in the garden of
my home at Greenfield, Wis., U.S.A. among plants of the
‘Little Doll’ variety (non-patented in the United States). The
female parent (i.e., seed parent) is believed to be the ‘Little
Doll’ variety. The male parent (i.e., pollen parent) is
unknown. Such presumed parentage of the new cultivar of the
present invention can be expressed as follows:

‘Little Doll’×Unknown.

The new variety of the present invention was carefully
preserved and has been further studied and evaluated. Had the
new variety of the present invention not been discovered and
preserved it would have been lost to mankind.

It was found that the new *Tradescantia* plant of the present
invention exhibits the following combination of characteris-
tics:

- (a) displays a spreading mounded growth habit,
- (b) forms attractive linear green leaves with substantially
parallel venation,
- (c) forms in abundance large purple flowers in clusters on
a substantially uniform basis,
- (d) propagates readily through the use of cuttings, and
- (e) is well suited for providing distinctive ornamentation.

The new cultivar of the present invention well meets the
needs of the horticultural industry and expands the choice of
herbaceous perennials. It is especially well suited for provid-
ing ornamentation in gardens and residential settings. The

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plant performs particularly well as a border planting, and
when grown in containers. Attractive purple flowers com-
monly are abundantly formed from June to November. The
growing requirements for the new cultivar are generally com-
parable to those of the species. The purple blossom coloration
contrasts nicely with the green foliage.

The new variety can be readily distinguished from the
‘Little Doll’ variety by its larger plant size at maturity. More
specifically, when grown outdoors in the ground, the ‘Little
Doll’ commonly assumes a height of approximately 12 inches
compared to a height of 18 inches for the new variety. Also,
the ‘Little Doll’ variety commonly assumes a width of
approximately 18 inches compared to a width of approxi-
mately 24 inches for the new variety.

The new variety also can be readily distinguished from the
‘Bluestone’ variety (non-patented in the United States) and
the ‘Concord Grape’ variety (non-patented in the United
States). More specifically, the new variety forms blossoms in
greater abundance than the ‘Bluestone’ variety, and forms
larger flower buds and larger more blue flower clusters than
the ‘Concord Grape’ variety.

The use of node cuttings and division have been used to
asexually propagate the new variety at West Grove, Pa.,
U.S.A. It has been found that the distinctive combination of
characteristics of the new variety is firmly fixed and is reliably
transmitted to succeeding generations following such asexual
reproduction.

The new cultivar has been named ‘Radtrad’ and will be
marketed under the AMETHYST KISS trademark.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying photographs show typical mature
specimens of the new variety in color as reasonably true as it
is possible to make the same in an illustration of this character

while growing outdoors in containers in full sun at West Grove, Pa., U.S.A. The photographs were obtained during April, 2009.

FIG. 1 illustrates an overall view of a typical flowering plant.

FIG. 2 illustrates a closer view of the typical attractive blossoms and foliage.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

The following is a detailed description of the new cultivar that was obtained while observing plants during September 2011 when grown in containers outdoors at West Grove, Pa., U.S.A. The chart used in the identification color is The R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal Horticultural Society, London, England (1995 Edition or equivalent).

Botanical classification: *Tradescantia virginiana*, 'Radtrad'. Plant:

Habit.—Spreading and mounded.

Type.—Herbaceous perennial.

Height.—Approximately 18 inches including flowers at maturity when in bloom.

Width.—Approximately 24 inches including flowers at maturity when in bloom.

Leaflets:

Arrangement.—Cauline, alternate.

Shape.—Linear, sometimes with inward folding at mid-vein.

Length.—Approximately 32 cm on average when mature.

Width.—Approximately 1 cm on average at widest point when mature.

Margins.—Entire.

Apex.—Acuminate.

Base.—Perfoliate.

Texture.—Glabrous.

Venation.—Substantially parallel to length.

Petiole.—Absent.

Inflorescence:

Type.—Terminal umbel-like cyme subtended by two bracts.

Flowering season.—June to November.

Bracts.—Shape: linear similar to leaves. Length: commonly approximately 10.1 cm on average. Width: commonly approximately 1.3 cm at the widest point. Color: near Green Group 137A on upper and under surfaces.

Peduncle.—Absent.

Pedicels.—Length: commonly approximately 1.5 cm on average. Diameter: commonly approximately 6 mm on average. Color: near Purple Group 78A.

Buds.—Shape: generally ovoid. Length: commonly approximately 1 cm on average. Diameter: commonly up to 6 mm prior to opening. Color: Yellow-Green Group 144A commonly with Violet-Blue Group 93B visible between sepals.

Flower.—Type: single, actinomorphic to irregular. Diameter: commonly approximately 3.5 cm on average when fully open. Shape: hypogynous with petals arranged in an orbicular configuration. Petal number: three. Petal length: commonly approximately 1.8 cm on average. Petal width: commonly approximately 2

cm on average. Petal margin: entire. Petal tip: generally obtuse. Petal base: attenuate. Petal texture: glabrous on upper and under surfaces. Petal color: near Violet-Blue Group 89C on the upper surface, and near Violet-Blue Group 89D on the under surface. Fragrance: none observed.

Sepal number.—Three or four per individual flower.

Sepal shape.—Lanceolate.

Sepal texture.—Short pubescence on outer surface.

Sepal margin.—Entire.

Sepal apex.—Acute.

Sepal base.—Truncate.

Sepal length.—Commonly approximately 1.2 cm on average.

Sepal width.—Commonly approximately 6 mm at widest point.

Sepal color.—When fully open near Yellow-Green Group 144B on the upper surface, and near Yellow-Green Group 144A on the under surface.

Stamen number.—Six per flower.

Filament length.—Approximately 8 mm on average.

Filament color.—Violet-Blue Group 89C.

Filament texture.—Commonly covered with fine hairs below anther.

Anther shape.—Reniform.

Anther length.—Approximately 1 mm on average.

Anther color.—Near Yellow-Orange Group 14A.

Pollen quantity.—Abundant.

Pollen color.—Yellow-Orange Group 14A.

Pistil number.—One per flower.

Pistil length.—Approximately 8 mm on average.

Style length.—Approximately 6 mm on average.

Style color.—Near Violet-Blue Group 89C.

Stigma color.—Near Yellow-White Group 145C.

Ovary size.—Commonly approximately 2 mm in length.

Fruit and seeds.—None observed.

Development:

Blooming.—Commonly during June to November.

Resistance to diseases.—Believed to be typical of the genus during observations to date.

Resistance to pests.—Believed to be typical of the genus during observations to date.

Hardiness.—Hardy in U.S.D.A. Hardiness Zone Nos. 5 to 10.

Plants of the 'Radtrad' variety have not been observed under all possible environmental conditions to date. Accordingly, it is possible that the phenotypic expression may vary somewhat with changes in light intensity and duration, cultural practices, and other environmental conditions.

I claim:

1. A new and distinct *Tradescantia* plant that exhibits the following combination of characteristics:

- (a) displays a spreading mounded growth habit,
- (b) forms attractive linear green leaves with substantially parallel venation,
- (c) forms in abundance large purple flowers in clusters on a substantially uniform basis,
- (d) propagates readily through the use of cuttings, and
- (e) is well suited for providing distinctive ornamentation; substantially as illustrated and described.

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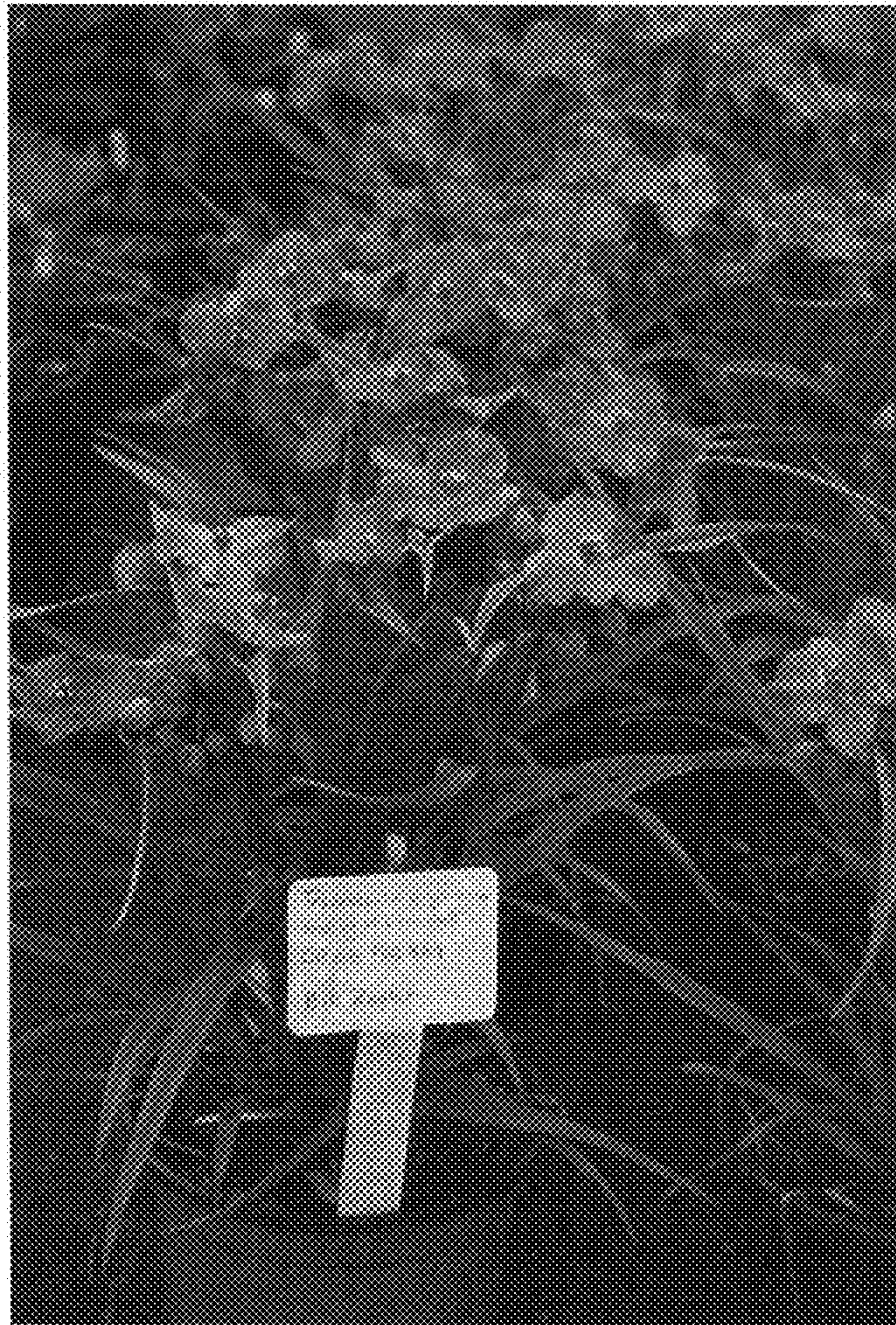


FIG. 1



FIG. 2